FOR CHARITIES, COMMUNITY GROUPS AND ALTERNATIVE PROVISION

Full cost and cost-per-outcome analysis

What each project really costs to run, including its fair share of core costs, so you can ask for it.

Who it's for

- Charities preparing a core-costs or full-cost-recovery request
- Organisations whose grants pay for projects but not the overheads that make them possible
- Alternative provision providers setting or reviewing the price of a placement

The question it answers

What does each project, service or placement really cost once rent, management, admin and other shared costs are fairly shared out, and what does that mean per participant, per session and per outcome?

What you get

- Full cost of each project or service: direct costs plus a fair, explained share of core costs
- Cost per participant, per session and per outcome, for each count you record (cost per outcome needs outcome counts)
- Where core costs are under-recovered: the gap between what funders pay for and what delivery actually costs
- For placements: the full cost of a placement day or session, to compare with what you charge
- A 2–3 page summary with charts and plain-English commentary, plus the workbook so you can update it next year
- A short costed paragraph you can drop into a core-costs or full-cost-recovery application

What I need from you

- Your latest annual or management accounts
- A list of projects or services and which costs belong to each (a rough split is fine to start)
- Activity counts: participants, sessions or placement days per project
- Any outcome counts you already record

How it works

- 20-minute call to agree the projects and how shared costs will be split
- You share your accounts and summary activity figures
- Summary and workbook delivered within 7 working days
- One round of changes and a 30-minute walk-through included

Example finding

The youth project looked cheap at £18 a session in the grant budget. With its share of rent, supervision and admin included it cost £31 a session, and the difference had been quietly covered from reserves for two years.

Illustrative example only, not a client result.

£350–£600 fixed price

Depends on the number of projects and cost centres, and is confirmed before any work starts. Invoiced on booking, payable on delivery. No VAT is added.

Best time: Before a core-costs application or contract renewal, or when setting next year's prices.

Your data. This uses your accounts and summary activity counts only. No names or personal details are needed.

Next step: email **stephen@zktheory.org** with a line about what you need and when it's due. I'll reply within two working days with whether I can help and a fixed price.